violent, 'spiritual cosmopolitanism'. His reception was mixed. He had his admirers among intellectuals, artists, and students, but as in Japan, he came under criticism. The trip left him somewhat bitter and must be counted a failure if the intent was to propagate a sense of cosmopolitanism and non-violent emancipation.

Whatever Tagore's intent, he was roundly denounced and ridiculed, particularly by leftist/communist revolutionaries, old and young, including former admirers and translators of his work. He was seen as extolling traditional, feudal Asia and romanticizing the Orient against the material, industrial Occident. His critics argued that China had to emulate the West in respect of science and reason, not fall back into tradition and spiritualism. Ramachandra Guha quotes the Chinese scholar Wu Chih-hui's scathing and cruel judgement: 'Mr Tagore . . . a petrified fossil of India's national past, had retreated into the tearful eyes and dripping noses of the slave people of a conquered country, seeking happiness in a future life, squeaking like the hub of a wagon wheel that needs oil'. Guha notes that in a poll of over a thousand students at Peking University in 1923–24, over 700 students wanted revolution in China. Nearly half admired Soviet Russia over the US. And in a list of international leaders that they most respected, Lenin got the most votes by far (227), with Tagore getting a mere 17 votes and Gandhi receiving only 9.[25]

Indian Perceptions of China and the Chinese

What about Indian attitudes towards China? The short answer is that we have no detailed picture of their perceptions of the Chinese in the nineteenth and early twentieth centuries. On the other hand, we do have some evidence relating to the Chinese communities in India and of elite Indian views of China.

The Chinese in India